



You can sync pictures, videos, documents and other files across various devices

as well as one other computer. Comparatively, you can also consider using software enabled extended storage devices like the Western Digital MyCloud external hard disks. These devices not only give your massive extra storage at reasonable prices but also come with an onboard DLNA media server software which essentially allows you to access data on it via wireless devices.

But for those who want to do it free and rough, in the second scenario with your salvaged Chrome OS machine serving as the personal cloud, the best option available is the ownCloud software and Chrome extension. So far ownCloud hasn't been ported to Chrome OS but can be accessed via URLs on other machines for back and forth data transfers. The system can be set up fairly quickly and accessing it only requires you to know the IP address of the host computer and the assigned port. It is a slower option compared to the paid for services as it takes time to scan and index all your data but once you've managed to set it up it works surprisingly well for a free option.

The Chrome OS outside of Google's Chromebook type devices is untethered and constantly evolving. The developer community continues to create and release patches and options that enhance its connectivity features making the idea of cloud computing more personal and seamless. The key to making the most of your Chromebooks is to constantly keep experimenting with the system by following up on newer builds and add-ons, you will be surprised as to what you may discover as Chrome OS gains even more popularity. 